2.2 Determining the value proposition of the application

One of the key goals of BDD is to ensure that everyone has a clear understanding of what a project is trying to deliver, and of the underlying business objectives of the project. This, in itself, goes a long way toward ensuring that the application actually meets these objectives.

You can achieve this by working with users and other stakeholders to define or clarify a set of high-level business goals for the application. These goals should provide a concise vision of what you need to build. Business goals are about delivering value, so it's common to see them expressed in terms of increasing or protecting revenue, or of decreasing costs.

In this case, the aim of the application you have to build is to provide train schedules and real-time updates for commuters. You could express the primary business goal behind this application like this:

```
Increase ticket sales revenue by making it easier and more time-efficient to
    travel by train
```

Understanding and defining these goals makes it much easier to determine the relative value of a proposed feature. For example, a feature that notifies commuters if their train is late would contribute to the overall goal, because it would give travellers the opportunity to change their plans accordingly. On the other hand, a feature that lets commuters rate railway stations might not be considered to be of particularly high value.

2.3 Requirements analysis: discovering and understanding features

Once you have a better understanding of the high-level goals of your application, you can work with the stakeholders to determine exactly what they need to achieve these goals. This typically involves defining a set of features that the application will need in order to deliver the value you're after.

For this chapter, assume you've agreed with the stakeholders on the following essential features:

- Provide travellers with optimal itineraries.
- Provide real-time train timetable information about service delays to travellers.
- Allow commuters to record their favorite trips.
- Notify commuters if their train is late.

Let's look at how you might describe some of these features.

2.3.1 Describing features

Once you have a general idea of the features you want to deliver, you need to describe them in more detail. There are many ways to describe a requirement.